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General Comment

Let me make it abundantly clear at the beginning of this comment: I am a former computer science student currently considering attending a graduate program for machine learning. I am well aware of the power AI holds. However, I think we, as a society, are:

1. Allowing advancements in a previously stagnant field to lead us to believe the technology is more advanced than it is.

2. Threatening the livelihood of many people in the way we use AI.

In regards to the first point, it is worth noting that the field of AI remained mostly stagnant for years, and up until the introduction of the GPT type of LLM in 2018 it remained that way. This advancement has led a lot of people and companies into believing that AI has reached AGI (artificial general intelligence, the theoretical point where an AI reaches human levels of intelligence). However, most of the people spouting this are company heads and investors, rather than engineers of AI itself. The people actually reasearching into AI mostly will say AGI is still years, if not decades away. However the rhetoric that it has been reached is still present, which leads companies and investors to over-invest into AI.

I firmly believe that this over-estimation is leading to an AI bubble, that is waiting to pop. The GPT model, whike powerful, is still limited, and will actively make mistakes due to computers, by design, doing exactly what they are told.

Regarding the second point: there are many fields that would directly be affected by reliance on AI being normalized. Art, music, writing, film, sciences in regards to calculations, software development...the list can go on. This leads me to my second point: in order for the security of multiple industries in America to exist, there needs to be a way to not allow AI to train on copyrighted data, or data that a person otherwise does not want to submit to train.

The solution to this is very simple, and is that copyrighted materials need a lisence to be used for training, and publicly posted materials can be opted in or out on a platform by platform basis (i.e. hypothetically X might allow AI to train on publicly posted material, but bluesky might not. These examples were chosen off the very reason for a mass exodus from X back in november of 2024).

Both of these points lead me to a very simple conclusion: AI is a very powerful tool, meant to make lives easier. However, if we were to fully remove the guardrails, we are banking on a volatile, subject to change technology, that realistically may destroy multiple job industries. In the best interest of America, while AI is worth studying more, it is not worth removing guardrails and allowing AI to train off all data unrestricted.